ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 4

SOCIAL SCIENCES

PAPER 1 · PRACTICE A

MARKS: 50 **TIME: 1 hour**

An end-of-year test on Grade 4 Social Sciences. Geography: map skills, food and farming in South Africa, and water in South Africa. History: transport through time and communication through time.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 4. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper has TWO sections: SECTION A (Geography) and SECTION B (History). Answer ALL the questions.
2. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
3. Read each question carefully before you answer.
4. Write neatly and in full sentences where you are asked to explain.

SECTION A: GEOGRAPHY

QUESTION 1: MAP SKILLS

Study the map of Green Valley Farm in FIGURE 1 and answer the questions.

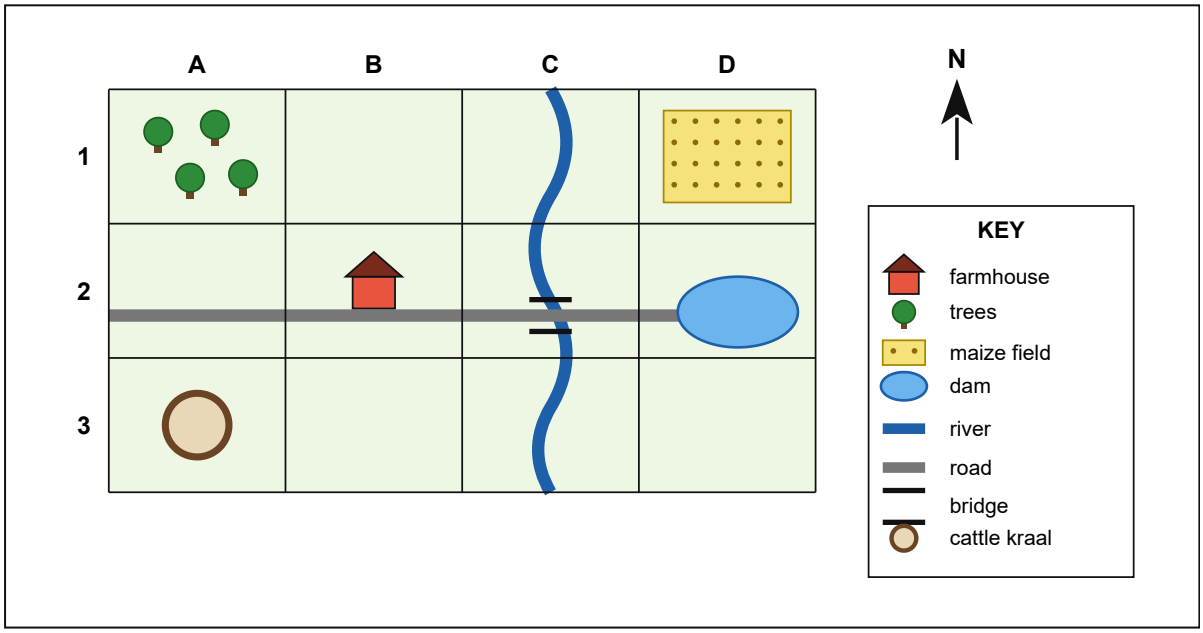


FIGURE 1: Map of Green Valley Farm

1.1 What is the purpose of the key on a map? (1)

1.2 In which block is the farmhouse? (1)

1.3 What is found in block D2? (1)

1.4 In which direction must the farmer travel from the farmhouse to reach the dam? (1)

1.5 Name the water feature that runs from north to south across the map. (1)

1.6 Why do you think the dam was built near the maize field? (1)

1.7 In which block is the cattle kraal? (1)

1.8 What has been built so that the road can cross the river? (1)

[8]

QUESTION 2: FOOD AND FARMING IN SOUTH AFRICA

2.1 Choose the correct word from the box for each description. Write only the word next to the question number.

crops · livestock · subsistence farmer · commercial farmer · irrigation

2.1.1 Animals that farmers keep, such as cattle, sheep and goats (1)

2.1.2 Plants that farmers grow for food, such as maize and wheat (1)

2.1.3 A farmer who grows food mainly to feed his or her own family (1)

2.1.4 A farmer who grows large amounts of food to sell (1)

2.1.5 Bringing water to crops through pipes, sprayers or canals (1)

2.2 Name TWO foods that we get from cows. (2)

2.3 Write these steps in the correct order to show how bread gets to us: **mill** (wheat is ground into flour), **shop**, **farm** (wheat is grown), **bakery**. (2)

[9]

QUESTION 3: WATER IN SOUTH AFRICA

3.1 Name TWO places where we get fresh water. (2)

3.2 Why do we say that South Africa is a dry (water-scarce) country? (1)

3.3 Give TWO ways your family can save water at home. (2)

3.4 Give ONE way that rivers become polluted. (1)

3.5 Why is it dangerous to drink dirty water? (1)

3.6 How can you make water safe to drink if you are not sure that it is clean? (1)

[8]

TOTAL SECTION A: [25]

SECTION B: HISTORY

QUESTION 4: TRANSPORT THROUGH TIME

4.1 Choose the correct answer. Write only the letter (A–D) next to the question number.

4.1.1 Long ago, before there were cars, people in southern Africa travelled mostly … (1)

A by aeroplane. B on foot and with animals.
C by train. D by bus.

4.1.2 The invention that made it possible for carts and wagons to move was the … (1)

A wheel. B engine. C sail. D rocket.

4.1.3 Sailing ships were moved by … (1)

A petrol. B steam. C the wind. D electricity.

4.1.4 The first aeroplane flight, in 1903, was made by … (1)

A the Wright brothers. B Henry Ford.
C Bartolomeu Dias. D Thomas Edison.

4.2 Read SOURCE A and answer the questions.

> **SOURCE A: Travelling by ox-wagon**
> In the 1800s many families in South Africa travelled long distances in ox-wagons. A team of up to 16 oxen pulled one wagon. On a good day a wagon could travel about 20 kilometres. Today a car can travel the same distance in about 15 minutes.

4.2.1 Which animals pulled the wagons? (1)

4.2.2 About how far could a wagon travel in one day? (1)

4.2.3 Give ONE reason why travelling by car is better than travelling by ox-wagon. (1)

4.2.4 Give ONE way that cars and trucks harm the environment. (1)

4.3 Name TWO kinds of public transport that people use in South Africa today. (2)

4.4 Explain how trains changed the lives of people in South Africa when railways were first built. (2)

4.5 What do we call a person who makes or thinks of something new for the first time? (1)

[13]

QUESTION 5: COMMUNICATION THROUGH TIME

5.1 Choose a description from COLUMN B that matches each way of communicating in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–E) next to the question number. (5)

COLUMN A	COLUMN B
5.1.1 Rock art	A Beating it sends sound signals over long distances
5.1.2 Drum	B Pictures painted on rocks by people long ago
5.1.3 Letter	C Talking to someone far away through wires
5.1.4 Telephone	D A written message sent by post
5.1.5 Cellphone	E A small phone you carry with you to call, SMS and send WhatsApp messages

5.2 Which people painted most of the rock art in southern Africa long ago? (1)

5.3 Give TWO ways people communicate today that were not possible 100 years ago. (2)

5.4 Give ONE advantage and ONE disadvantage of cellphones. (2)

5.5 Why are newspapers and radio stations important in a community? Give TWO reasons. (2)

[12]

TOTAL SECTION B: [25]

TOTAL: 50

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END OF QUESTION PAPER